

CHETAN BONDE

Global Procurement & Category Specialist · Strategic Sourcing · AI-Driven Digital Procurement

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven global procurement and category management professional with 5+ years of experience delivering cost transformation, strategic sourcing, and digital procurement innovation across complex, European-led multinational manufacturing environments.

Currently governing €10M annual spend across six countries at NV Bekaert SA (Euronext: BEKB; €3.96B revenue; ~27,000 employees; 130+ countries), achieving ~10% recurring savings through supplier consolidation, make-vs-buy analysis, and low-cost country sourcing.

Uniquely differentiated by applied AI, NLP, and automation capabilities — having engineered live tools deployed in a global MNC: an NLP-based SAP material de-duplication engine, an RPA + AI end-to-end PO automation that cut admin workload by 80–90%, and an AI-powered supplier finder. Combines a strong engineering foundation (B.Tech Mechanical, CGPA 8.85/10) with business management credentials (PGDM – Project Management and Supply Chain Analytics) and hands-on proficiency in SAP MM/BW, GEP, Python, Power BI, and RPA.

QUANTIFIED IMPACT

- ▶ €10M Annual Spend Governed — 6 Countries
- ▶ ~10% Recurring Savings — Supplier Consolidation & Low-Cost Country
- ▶ ~€21M CAPEX Savings (~30%) JCB Vadodara €70M Project
- ▶ >€150K Revenue — Scrap Monetization & Inventory Liquidation
- ▶ ~200,000 SKUs — Global Category & Demand Management
- ▶ 80–90% Admin Reduction — RPA + AI PO Automation
- ▶ 600+ Supplier Payment Terms Harmonized Globally
- ▶ 10-Year Long-Term Contracts Negotiated (JCB)

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Strategic Procurement & Category Management
- Global Sourcing & Low-Cost Country (LCC) Strategy
- CAPEX Procurement
- Make-vs-Buy Analysis
- Supplier Consolidation & Rationalization
- Contract Negotiation & TCO Modelling
- Spend Analysis
- RFQ / RFP / Tendering
- Supplier Relationship Management (SRM)
- Supplier Risk & EcoVadis Compliance
- Working Capital & Payment Terms
- MRO & Spare Parts
- S2P / P2P (SAP MM · GEP · SRM)
- Demand Planning & Inventory Management
- AI / NLP / Machine Learning
- Python & Data Science
- RPA & Power Automate
- SAP BW Power BI VBA Excel
- Digital Procurement Transformation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

NV Bekaert SA (Euronext Brussels: BEKB) | Steel Wire Transformation & Coating Technologies · Jan 2023 – Present

€3.96B revenue (2024) · ~27,000 employees · 62 plants · R&D in 23 countries · 130+ countries · HQ: Belgium

Procurement Category Specialist – Capital & Global Categories | Scope: Europe · Asia · USA

- ▶ Govern €10M annual spend across CAPEX, technical drawing parts, spare parts, process equipment, MRO, and global dies — owning the complete S2P/P2P lifecycle in SAP MM and GEP (sourcing events, SRM, contracts, POs, goods receipt, invoicing, system testing).
- ▶ Deliver ~10% recurring annual cost savings through supplier consolidation, make-vs-buy analysis, and sourcing shifts from EU/North America to India and China — validated through TCO models and formal savings reporting.

- ▶ Spearhead global demand management and material category consolidation across ~200,000 SKUs — coordinating forecast collection, delivery scheduling, and stock-out prevention across plants in China, India, Slovakia, Belgium, and North America.
- ▶ Execute supplier risk management and EcoVadis ESG compliance programmes — conducting performance evaluations, second-source qualification, and monopoly-risk mitigation.
- ▶ Negotiate supplier pricing, commercial terms, and global contracts independently; support high-value CAPEX negotiations — harmonized payment terms for 600+ suppliers globally, strengthening working capital and cash conversion.
- ▶ Monetize idle and obsolete inventory through structured liquidation and circular procurement — recovered >€150K in additional revenue from global dies scrap streamlining.
- ▶ Collaborate with European HQ (Belgium), Shared Service Centre (Hlohovec, Slovakia), China plants, and North America teams on pricing, supplier strategy, and savings targets — coaching SSC purchasing assistants on SAP/GEP processes.

AI & DIGITAL INITIATIVES — BEKAERT

- ▶ Engineered AI/NLP SAP Material Master De-duplication Tool — deployed fuzzy matching and linguistic pattern recognition to identify thousands of global duplicate material codes; improved spend visibility and eliminated emergency purchasing.
- ▶ Built end-to-end RPA + AI PO automation: bot issues PO → AI parses supplier email → SAP updated automatically → delivery scorecard refreshed → overdue reminders sent — achieved 80–90% admin workload reduction.
- ▶ Developed AI Supplier Finder Tool using NLP and SAP invoice data — surfaces approved suppliers for new requirements, reducing unnecessary vendor creation and improving AVL compliance.
- ▶ Constructed NLP brand/model extraction script for inconsistent material descriptions — enabled bundled RFQs and improved negotiation leverage through volume aggregation.
- ▶ Automated web scraping of supplier and market data for competitive benchmarking — accelerating sourcing cycle times and enriching SAP BW and Power BI spend analytics dashboards.

KEY OUTCOMES

- ▶ ~10% annual savings on €10M spend — verified through formal category savings reporting (2023–Present).
- ▶ >€150K in recovered revenue through scrap monetization and idle inventory liquidation programme.
- ▶ 80–90% PO admin reduction — live RPA + AI automation deployed across the procurement team.
- ▶ 600+ supplier payment terms harmonized globally — measurable improvement in working capital.

JCB Industries Pvt. Ltd. | Subsidiary of J.C. Bamford Excavators Ltd. (UK) · Jul 2020 — Dec 2022

£100M (~€115M) total Vadodara factory investment · 47-acre facility · 85,000T/yr steel · Exports to 110+ countries · Inaugurated by UK PM Boris Johnson, Apr 2022

Purchase Engineer — Greenfield CAPEX Procurement | Project Scope: ~€70M (₹600 Cr, 2020–22 avg rate)

- ▶ Executed end-to-end CAPEX procurement for the €70M portion of JCB's Vadodara greenfield facility — CNC machining centers, lathe machines, Trumpf laser cutting machines, forklifts, IT, utilities, and civil services.
- ▶ Delivered ~30% CAPEX savings (~€21M) through competitive RFQ/RFP tendering, multi-round supplier negotiations, make-vs-buy decisions, and value engineering across all procurement categories.
- ▶ Built procurement infrastructure from zero — SAP MM workflows, vendor master data, P2P governance, sourcing frameworks, and supplier onboarding protocols for a brand-new manufacturing operation.
- ▶ Negotiated 10-year long-term rental contracts for forklift fleet and logistics equipment — securing cost predictability, guaranteed service levels, and favorable escalation terms.
- ▶ Conducted historical spend analysis and techno-commercial evaluations — optimized payment term structures balancing supplier relationships with JCB's working capital requirements.

KEY OUTCOMES

- ▶ ~€21M CAPEX savings (~30%) on a €70M mandate — the largest single-project procurement exposure at this career stage.
- ▶ Full procurement infrastructure built from scratch — SAP, vendor master, P2P, and governance operational before Day 1.
- ▶ 10-year logistics rental contracts secured — long-term cost stability and service guarantee locked in.

TOOLS & TECHNOLOGY

Procurement Platforms: SAP MM · SAP BW · SAP SRM · GEP Smart (S2P / P2P / Sourcing / Contracts)

Analytics: Power BI · SAP BW · Advanced Excel · VBA

Automation & AI: Python (Pandas · NLP · Fuzzy Logic · Web Scraping) RPA · Power Automate · AI/NLP Tools · ChatGPT/LLMs

PM: MS Project

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

PGDM – Project Management | MIT School of Distance Education, Pune | 2026 (In Progress)

B.Tech – Mechanical Engineering | MIT Academy of Engineering, Pune | CGPA 8.85/10 | 2020

Diploma – Mechanical Engineering | Government Polytechnic, Khamgaon | 86.71% | 2017

Certifications: AI — Dell · Data Science Pro-Degree — Imarticus · CSCMP Supply Chain Foundations · Prompt Engineering with ChatGPT — LinkedIn · Project Management: Procurement — LinkedIn

GLOBAL EXPOSURE & MOBILITY

Active global procurement scope across Europe, Aisa, USA (SSC), through Bekaert's category mandate.

Daily collaboration with European HQ (Belgium), Shared Service Centre (Hlohovec, Slovakia), China plants, and North America teams.

CAPEX exposure at JCB Vadodara — exporting to 110+ countries. Open to global relocation: Europe, APAC, Middle East, or Americas.